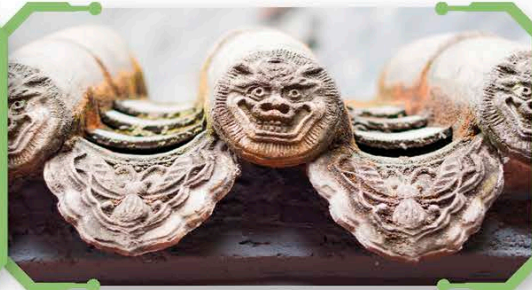


Rainproof roof

Tiles helped seal and protect tower roofs from rain. They were decorated at the roof ends with animals, plants, symbols, or even a *gao tie* ("monster face") which was meant to scare off evil spirits.



Carved creatures called roof guardians were said to bring good luck.

Rice is a staple of the guards' diet, so there is always lots of it in storage.

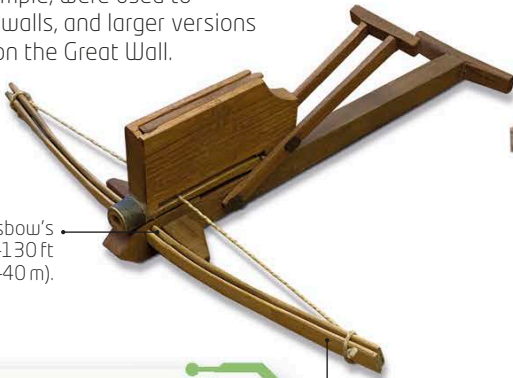
The *pufang* sits directly in the middle of the tower roof.

Stone for the tower's bricks was all mined from hills nearby.

Crossbow

Chinese people used crossbows for around 2,000 years. Smaller ones, like this example, were used to defend city walls, and larger versions were used on the Great Wall.

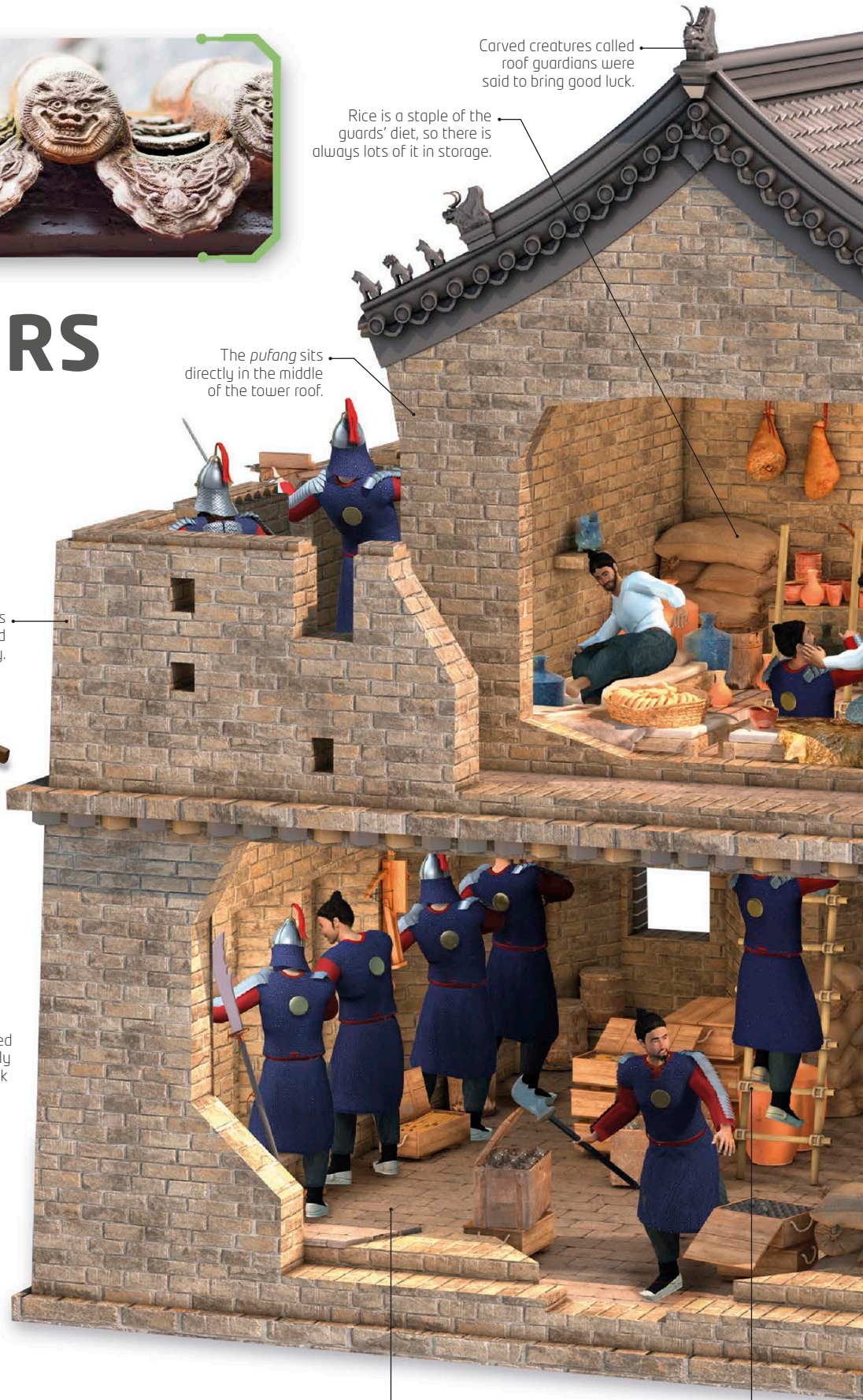
A small crossbow's range is 100-130 ft (30-40 m).



Explosive ammunition

Each tower had a good supply of cannonballs. Although they look solid, each iron ball was hollow and filled with gunpowder, causing the ball to explode when it hit the ground.

Crossbows are stored in the tower and only used when an attack takes place.



The largest towers have stone or brick floors, which makes them easy to keep clean and dry. Smaller towers have floors made of earth.

Although some towers have stone or brick stairs between each level, this one just has a bamboo ladder. This makes it hard to carry heavy loads up and down.

